



ENGLAND FOOTBALL
LEARNING

Session programme

Attacking skills



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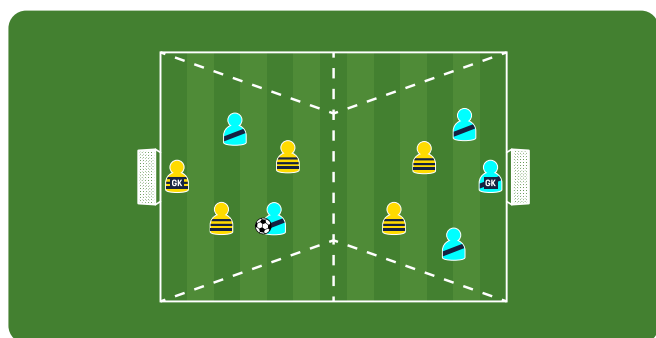
Week one: 2v2 to score

This session will help players:

- pass and receive in tight areas
- work with teammates to create space
- know when to pass or shoot.

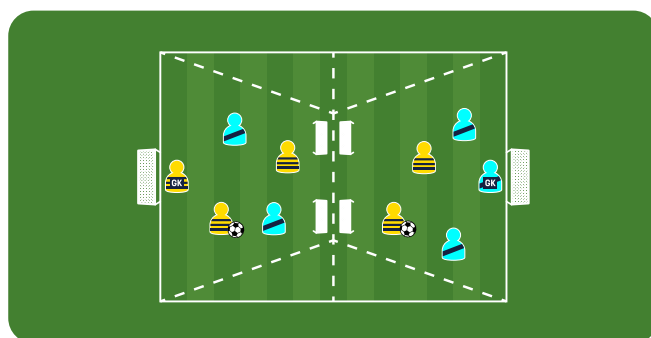
Coaching points

- Look for players' movement to receive, technique to receive and shoot, and their creativity in tight areas.
- Encourage players to think about how they can use their scanning, movement and deception skills effectively to find the best solution.
- Get players to consider how they can help create space and become a passing option for their teammate when they're not on the ball.
- Ask players to be brave and stay on the ball for the right amount of time. They might be able to move the defender and get an opportunity to shoot early by being creative in possession.



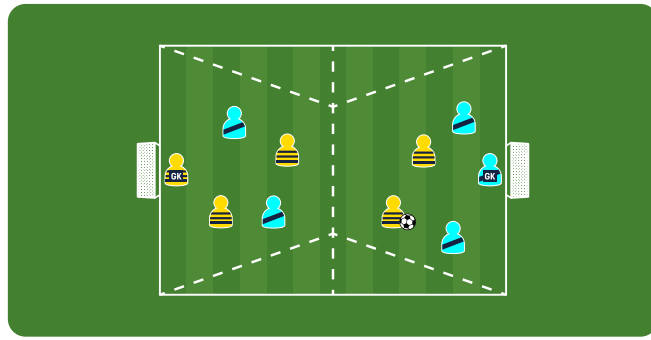
Arrival activity

- Create a pitch with a halfway line and a goal at each end
- Use flat markers to make a second pitch within that, one which is wide near the goals and narrow towards the halfway line to create the area for the next activity
- Play a normal 5v5 game using the whole pitch



Practice one

- Put two mini-goals either side of the halfway line
- This splits your original pitch into two smaller ones and creates a 2v2 with a goalkeeper in the bigger goal
- The two attackers need to combine to score in the big goal, while the defenders try to win the ball back and score in the mini-goals



Practice two

- Remove the mini-goals and return to the original 5v5 game
- Observe how the players now combine with team-mates after the 'part' section of the session

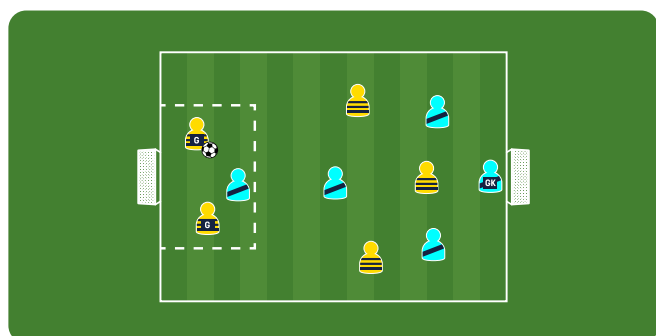
Week two: create to score

This session will help players:

- link up with teammates
- use movement to make space
- get repetition of passing and receiving
- practise finishing.

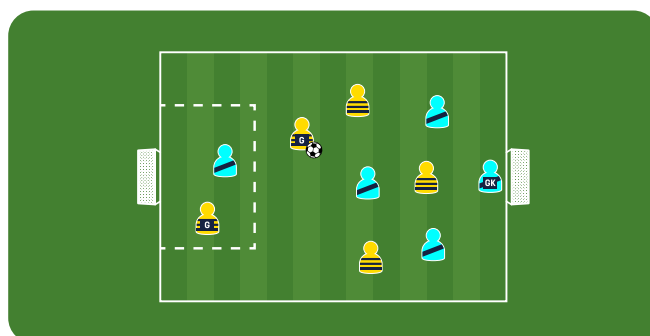
Coaching points

- Encourage players to scan. They need to know where their opponents and teammates are. This will help them decide when to pass, turn, or stay on the ball.
- Consider the six capabilities when observing your players. Think about:
 - their positioning to receive
 - their movement to get on the ball or create space for others
 - the timing of their runs to stay onside
 - the techniques used to pass and receive
 - how they display the six capabilities when it comes to finishing.



Arrival activity

- Create a pitch with a goal at each end for this 5v5 game
- Put a square area around one goal
- The attackers have five outfielders, with two locked in the square guarding their goal
- The defenders have a keeper and four outfielders, with one locked in the square
- Both sides look to combine to score



Practice one

- Progress the activity by allowing one of the attacking team's players out of the square
- This creates an overload in the middle of the pitch and leaves a 1v1 in the box

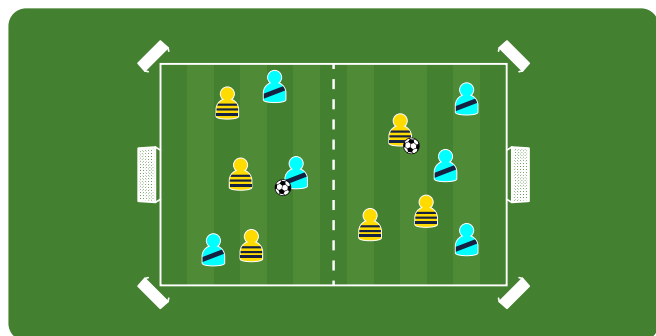
Week three: pass, turn, score

This session will help players:

- pass and turn under pressure
- know when and where to pass and turn
- combine with teammates
- practise finishing.

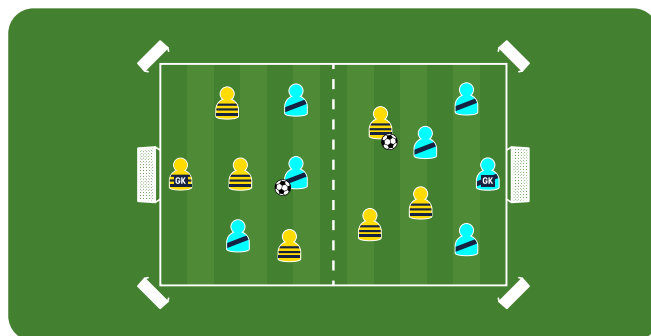
Coaching points

- Make sure players rotate so they get a chance to attack and defend.
- As it's a narrow pitch, get players to consider how their positioning and movement off the ball can support their teammates. Go-to-show movements can be beneficial. This is where a player runs away, then comes back to receive a pass in the space that's been created.
- Think about the six core capabilities. Encourage players to think about how they can use deception when passing, turning or shooting. Look for:
 - scanning to inform decision-making of when to pass, turn and shoot
 - positioning to turn and play forward
 - how players use turning as a means of deception
 - the technique of passes, turns and shots
 - timing of passes, turns and shots.



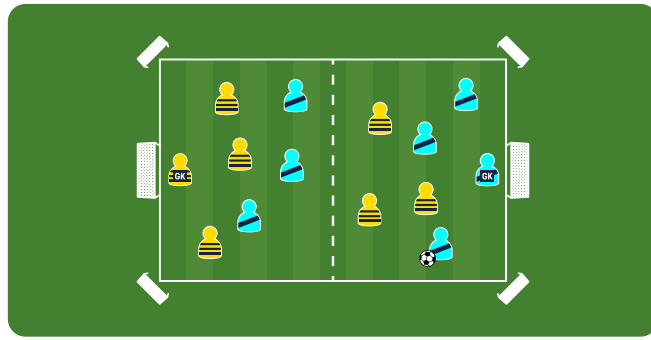
Arrival activity

- Create a narrow pitch with a halfway line. Put a large goal and two mini-goals at each end
- Have a 3v3 in each half
- The attacking team start with the ball in each half – they combine with teammates to try to score
- Scoring in the large goal is worth one point. Scoring in a mini-goal is worth two



Practice one

- Progress this practice by bringing in your two goal-keepers from their own activity
- Put one in each large goal
- You can amend the scoring system to reflect this change and encourage the attacking team to aim for the larger goal



Practice two

- Play one big game using the large goals but start with players being locked in their halves
- Players need to win the ball and pass it to their teammates in the other half so they can try to score
- Progress this further by allowing players to step in to create an overload

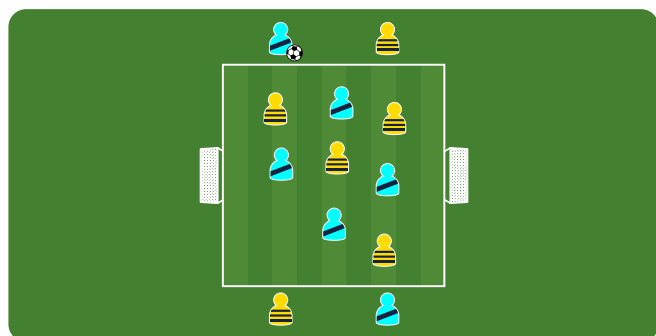
Week four: width for deception

This session will help players:

- know when, how and why to use width
- work on different types of crosses
- develop their movement skills to get out wide
- practise finishing from a cross into the box.

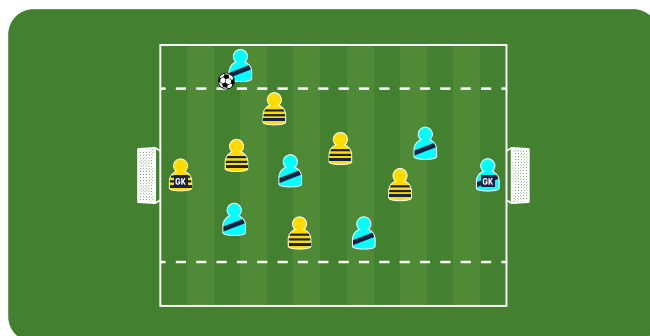
Coaching points

- Observe how teams use the wide channels. Get players thinking about when the best time is to use them and how using the channels can provide their team with space and options. For example, if things are crowded in central areas, playing it out wide moves the opposition around and provides the attacking team with more space.
- Encourage players to think about the type of cross they could use and to try different ones. For example, using a cut-back cross when near the byline, or crossing early and deep to the back post.
- Ask players to think about how the timing of their runs into the channels and the box can help create space – and provide their teammates with a passing option.



Arrival activity

- Set up a small area for a 4v4 – put a goal at each end
- Each team also has two wide players outside the area – one on each side of the pitch
- Teams need to work with all their teammates to make four passes
- Then they can try to score in either goal
- Play for three rounds



Practice one

- Create a wide pitch with a goal at each end for a 6v6 practice
- Use flat markers to create channels out wide on both sides
- Players take part in a normal game but should naturally make use of the width
- You can add scoring systems to encourage teams to cross and score from the channels

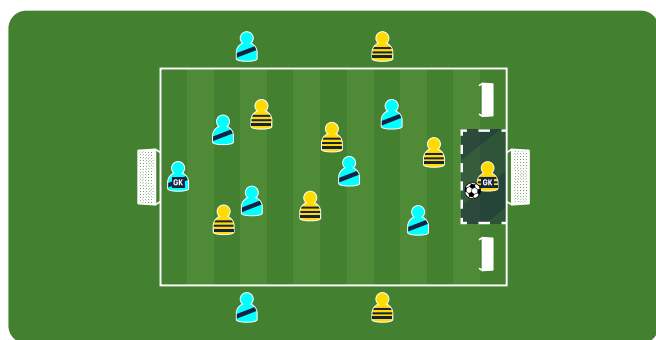
Week five: playing out to attack

This session will help players:

- develop confidence on the ball under pressure
- improve passing and receiving skills
- use combination play to create goalscoring opportunities
- work on finishing.

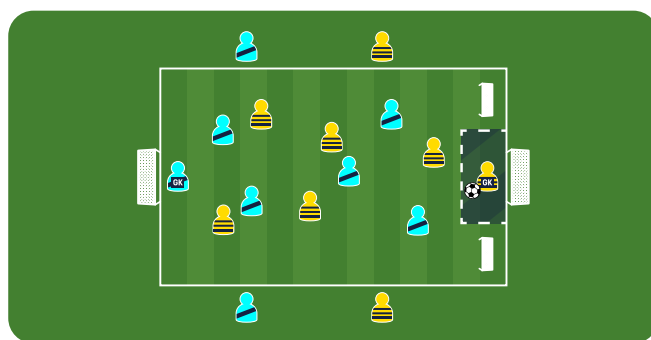
Coaching points

- Ask players to consider how their positioning can help the team to retain possession or play forward. Positioning is crucial. If a player has clear passing options, they will be more confident when on the ball and under pressure.
- Encourage teams to use two-player and three-player core moves to unlock the opposition.
- Observe the timing and technique players use to finish.



Practice one

- Place a goal at each end, with a 10x20-yard safe zone around one and two mini-goals nearby
- Each team has a player on each wing outside the area
- The attacking team start with the ball and combine to score
- If the defenders win possession, they score in a mini-goal or pass to the opposing keeper



Practice one – continued

- Progress this activity by allowing wide players to come inside to create an overload when they receive the ball
- You can also allow the defending team to attack and score in the large goal

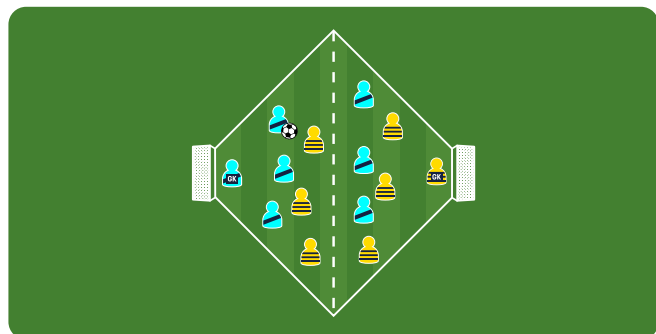
Week six: scoring as a team

This session will help players:

- get repetition of finishing
- shoot from different distances
- understand roles and responsibilities around scoring in game situations
- understand security behind the ball.

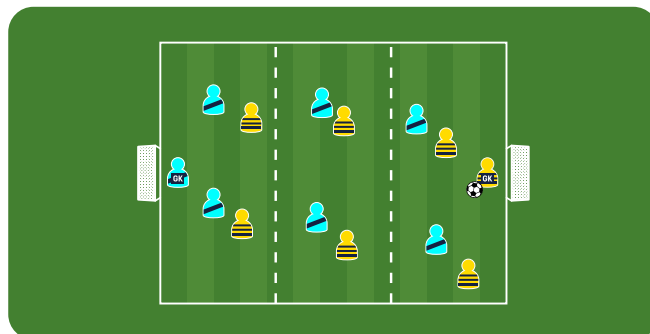
Coaching points

- Encourage players to take shots whenever there's a good chance to score. After all, this session is all about creating and finishing loads of goalscoring opportunities. Plus, shooting early can catch the opposition off guard. Goalkeepers will find it harder to set themselves for an early strike compared to when a player takes loads of touches before shooting.
- Reassure players if they miss a chance and encourage them to go again. Having a positive mindset is really important when it comes to scoring. So, if a chance is missed, there's always another opportunity around the corner that players need to be ready for.
- Get players to think about how they can create space for themselves and others to help their team build and finish an attack. Going away from the ball, running beyond a player, moving with the ball and even how you receive the ball can all change the space that's available.
- Ask players to consider their positioning. As a team, they need to create an attack but also provide cover and balance if they lose the ball and need to defend.



Arrival activity

- Create a 35-yard diamond area
- Have a halfway line and two goals
- Lock players in to have a 3v3 and a keeper in each half
- To start, a team gets a free pass to give it to their teammates in the other half – they try to score
- Then the game goes back and forth
- Players stay locked in but can tackle



Practice one

- Create a pitch split into thirds for a small-sided game – players aren't locked into thirds
- A keeper starts with the ball and distributes it anywhere
- Once it's worked into the final third players can't play more than three passes before shooting
- The opposition get the ball if this is breached